

COLD START

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Your onboarding doc is a promise.
This is the receipt.

IBM Bob 2.0 Hackathon · September 2026

THE PROBLEM

Setup guides rot. Nobody notices, because the people who wrote them never follow them again.

Now teams point AI agents at those guides. Agents are very good at getting around a broken instruction without telling you.

WHAT WE DID

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- 01 14 steps, one headless IBM Bob session each, four at a time
 - 02 each on its own clean clone
 - 03 a deterministic check runs after Bob exits – no model, one exit code
 - 04 every session recorded verbatim and committed
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THE RESULT

	BEFORE	AFTER THE PATCH
Cost to walk the guide	\$1.51	\$1.06
Wasted	\$1.02	\$0.00
Steps that cannot work	4 of 14	0 of 14
Bob claimed success, check disagreed	3 of 13	0

Target: sqlfluff/sqlfluff @ c7401613 · 1 Bobcoin = \$0.50, IBM published rate

THE FINDING

The guide says:

```
tox -e cov-init,dbt019-py310,...
```

Reality:

There is no dbt019 environment.

Bob said:

“(substituting whichever dbt version – 170, 180, 190, or 1100
– you actually want to test against.)”

Bob reported:

task complete. It never said the documentation was wrong.

That is why “the agent said it worked” cannot be the verdict.